

Sydnee Christian Caldwell

Contact Information

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Current Positions

Visiting Assistant Professor, SIEPR, Stanford University	2025–2026
University of California, Berkeley	
Assistant Professor, Haas School of Business, Economic Analysis and Policy (EAP) group	2020–
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics	2020–

Current Affiliations

RFBerlin Research Fellow	2025–
Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco	2025–
Faculty Affiliate, UC Berkeley Stone Center for Inequality	2026–
Research Affiliate, MIT Stone Center on Inequality and Shaping the Future of Work	2024–
Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research (Labor Studies)	2023–

Previous Positions

Post-doctoral Researcher, Microsoft Research New England	2019–2020
Senior Research Analyst, Federal Reserve Bank of New York	2012–2013

Education

Ph.D. (Economics), Massachusetts Institute of Technology	2013–2019
B.A. (Applied Mathematics, Economics), University of California, Berkeley	2008–2012
Greatest Distinction, Highest Honors in Economics	

Fellowships & Honors

Barbara and Gerson Bakar Faculty Fellow, Haas School of Business	2020–2025
Schwabacher Fellow (highest honor given to junior faculty at the Haas School of Business)	2024–2025
Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco	2022–2023
Hellman Faculty Fellowship, UC Berkeley	2022–2024
Referee Prize, <i>Economic Journal</i>	2022
Excellence in Refereeing Award, <i>AER: Insights</i>	2019 & 2020 & 2023
W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research Dissertation Award, First Prize	2019
Robert M. Solow Prize for Excellence in Research and Teaching	2019
<i>Review of Economic Studies</i> European Tour	2019
NSF Graduate Research Fellowship	2013–2018
MIT Department of Economics Fellowship	2013–2015
Economics Departmental Citation, UC Berkeley	2012
Earl Rolph Prize, UC Berkeley	2012
Phi Beta Kappa	2012
UC Berkeley Regents' and Chancellors' Scholar	2008–2012
UC Berkeley Alumni Association Leadership Award	2008–2012

Grants

Peder Sather Grant (for work with Andreas Kostøl)	2024–2026
Fritz Thyssen Foundation Grant (for work with Haegele and Heining)	2024–2027

Norwegian FRIPRO Grant #345236 (for work with Andreas Kostøl)	2024–2027
National Science Foundation Research Grant (SES 2242439)	2023–2026
UC Berkeley EGAL Research Grant	2022–2023
Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (IRLE) Grant	2022–2023
W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research, Early Career Research Award	2022–2023
Joachim Herz Foundation Grant (for work with Haegele and Heining)	2022–2025
UC Berkeley Economics Grant for Gender Research	2021–2022
UC Berkeley EGAL Research Grant	2020–2021
Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (IRLE) Grant	2020–2021
Russell Sage Foundation Presidential Grant (with Marco Tabellini)	2020–2021
NSF Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant	2017–2019
Washington Center for Equitable Growth (WCEG) Doctoral Grant	2016–2017
Washington Center for Equitable Growth (WCEG) Doctoral Grant (with Scott Nelson & Daniel Waldinger)	2015–2016
George & Obie Schulz Fund Grants	2015, 2016

Teaching

Graduate Labor Economics (Econ 250B), UC Berkeley	Fall 2020, 2022, 2023
Data & Decisions (full-time MBA program, 2 sections/year), UC Berkeley	Fall 2020–2024

Working Papers

- “[Why Workers Stay: Pay, Beliefs, and Attachment](#)” with Ingrid Haegele and Joerg Heining
NBER Working Paper #33445, *Revise and Resubmit **Journal of Political Economy***
- “[Firm Pay, Amenities, and Inequality](#)” with Ingrid Haegele and Joerg Heining
NBER Working Paper, #35149, Under Review
- “[Outside Options and Labor Supply: Evidence from the Gig Economy](#)” with Emily Oehlsen
- “[Outside Options, Bargaining, and Wages: Evidence from Coworker Networks](#)” with Nikolaj Harmon
- “[Monopsony Makes it Big](#)” with Arindrajit Dube and Suresh Naidu
(*Revised and Resubmitted, **Journal of Economic Literature***)

Published and Accepted Papers

- “[Bargaining and Inequality in the Labor Market](#)” (with Ingrid Haegele and Joerg Heining)
2026, **Quarterly Journal of Economics**
- “[Outside Options in the Labor Market](#)” (with Oren Danieli)
2024, **Review of Economic Studies**
- “[Tax Refund Uncertainty: Evidence and Welfare Implications](#)” (with Scott Nelson & Daniel Waldinger)
2023, **American Economic Journal: Applied Economics**
- “[Uber versus Taxi: A Driver’s Eye View](#)” (with Joshua Angrist & Jonathan Hall)
2021, **American Economic Journal: Applied Economics**

Book Chapters

- “[Wage and employment implications of U.S. labor market monopsony and possible policy solutions](#)” with Suresh Naidu, *Equitable Growth Vision 2020*

Professional Service

Program Committees and Workshop Organization:

2026	Co-Organizer, Micro and Macro Labor Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco (with Nicolas Petrosky-Nadeau and Lindsey Uniat)
2025, 2026	Co-Organizer LaSeR Conference (with Isaac Sorkin)
2025	Co-Organizer, NBER Gender in the Economy: Women in the Digital World Conference (with Jessica Goldberg and Tavneet Suri)
2024	Program Committee, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies
2024	Co-Organizer, Stanford SITE: The Micro & Macro of Labor Markets (with Gregor Jarosch, Benjamin Schoefer, and Isaac Sorkin)
2023	Co-Organizer, West Coast Junior Labor Economics Conference (with Isaac Sorkin)
2022	Program Committee, Society of Labor Economists Annual Meeting
2021	Program Committee, EEAMO
2020	Program Committee, Market Design for Social Good Workshop

Referee: American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, Applied Economics, Econometrica, Economic Journal, European Economic Review, Journal of Economic Inquiry, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics

Grant Reviewer: National Science Foundation, JPAL North America, European Research Council

Panel Discussions and Other Talks

2026 IAB 2nd Workshop on Imperfect Competition in the Labor Market, Keynote

2025 IZA PhD Workshop in Labor and Behavioral Economics, Keynote

2024 Federal Reserve Bank of New York Symposium on the US Labor Market in the 21st Century, Panelist for “Competition in the Labor Market” Session (with Simon Mongey and Pascual Restrepo)

2023 Economics for Inclusive Prosperity Conference at Harvard Kennedy School, Panelist for “Labor Market and Wage Dynamics After COVID” Session (with Simon Jaeger and Nathan Wilmers)

2021 NBER Conference on Wage Dynamics in the 21st Century Panelist: session on “Market Power in the Labor Market” (with David Card and Alan Manning)

Discussions

2025 NBER Digital Economics and AI Discussant “Monopsony Power and the Gig Economy” by Fisher

2024 Hoover Institute Conference on the Economics of Immigration Discussant: “Monopsony, Efficiency, and the Regularization of Undocumented Immigrants” by Borjas and Edo

2023 San Francisco Federal Reserve Micro-Macro Conference Discussant: “Earnings Inequality in Production Networks” by Hunees, Kroft & Lim

2021 NBER Japan Project Meeting Discussant: “AI, Skill and Productivity: The Case of Taxi Drivers” by Kanazawa, Kawaguchi, Shigeoka & Watanabe

2021 NBER Summer Institute (Labor Studies) Discussant: “Monopsony and the Wage Effects of Migration” by Amior and Manning

2020 NLS-E Discussant: “Monopsony, Skills, and Labor Market Concentration” by Dodini, Lovenheim, Salvanes, & Willen

Seminars and Conference Presentations

- 2026-2027 *Scheduled:* Trans-Pacific Labor Conference
- 2025-2026 Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland, Atlanta Fed Employment Conference, Tilburg University, Norwegian School of Economics FAIR Seminar, University of California, Davis, Kellogg School of Management (Strategy), Federal Reserve Board, Utrecht University, Stanford University, University of California, Santa-Barbara (Macro Seminar), Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, University of Chicago (Becker Seminar), *Scheduled:* JoshCon, IAB Workshop on Imperfect Competition in the Labor Market (Keynote), Bank of Portugal and Bank of Spain Workshop in Labor Economics, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies/Personnel (Joint Session)
- 2024-2025 MIT Sloan IWER, Harvard Kennedy School (Stone Inequality Seminar, Economics & Social Policy Seminar), Federal Reserve Bank of New York Symposium on the US Labor Market (Panelist, Competition in the Labor Market), University of Virginia, Cornell, AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting (presenter, 2x discussant), Central European University, University of Lausanne, Boston College, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy, Hiring and Job Search Workshop (in Innsbruck), Berlin Applied Microeconomics Seminar, UC Berkeley Conference on Minimum Wages and Monopsony, IZA PhD Workshop in Labor and Behavioral Economics (Keynote), Society of Labor Economics Annual Meeting, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies
- 2023-2024 University of Calgary, Columbia University, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco Micro-Macro Labor Conference (discussant), Empirical Management Conference (at Stanford), London School of Economics CEP, University College London, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Stockholm University, Berkeley Macro Labor Conference, Society of Labor Economists Annual Meeting, Rochester Labor Economics conference, West Coast Junior Labor Conference, Stanford University, Behavioral Economics Design Initiative Conference, Yale Cowles Conference on Labor & Public Economics, CEPR Annual Symposium in Labor Economics, Micro-Macro Labor workshop at the University of Konstanz, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies
- 2022-2023 BFI Women in Empirical Microeconomics Conference, CIREQ Montreal Applied Economics Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, Workshop on Labor Economics (at Hamburg), Friedrich-Alexander University of Erlangen-Nuremberg/IAB Macro-Labor Seminar, University of California, Santa-Barbara, Economics for Inclusive Prosperity Conference (panelist), Southern California Conference in Applied Microeconomics (SOCCAM), University of California, Santa Cruz, IAB Workshop on Wage Determination and Job Skills, West Coast Junior Labor Conference, Norwegian Workshop on Labor Economics, BI Norwegian Business School, Society for Economic Dynamics Annual Meeting, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies/Personnel (Joint Session)
- 2021-2022 Texas A&M Labor and Public Conference, Arizona State University, NBER Japan Project Meeting (Discussant), AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, Trans-Pacific Labor Conference (UC Berkeley IRLE), UCSB/LAEF Labor Markets and Macroeconomic Outcomes Conference, University of Johannesburg, Duke University, KOF Swiss Economic Institute/ETH Zurich/University of Zurich Joint Seminar, NBER Trans-Atlantic Public Economics Seminar: Economic Behavior and Inequality, EIEF 5th Rome Junior Conference on Applied Microeconomics, Bank of Italy, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies

- 2020-2021 Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics: Micro and Macro of Labor Markets, Mechanism Design for Social Good (MD4SG) Conference, University of Nevada-Reno, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, University of Oxford, Bilkent University, University of Chicago, University of Uppsala, Washington Center for Equitable Growth Grantee Conference (discussant), University of British Columbia, Harvard (Economics), University of Toronto-Rotman (Strategy), Northeast Labor Symposium for Early Career Economists (NLS-E Princeton), NBER Conference on Wage Dynamics in the 21st Century (panelist), University of Melbourne, NBER Summer Institute: Labor Studies (Discussant)
- 2019-2020 Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics: Micro and Macro of Labor Markets, Advances with Field Experiments Conference (at U Chicago), Brown University, University of Massachusetts-Amherst, University of Rochester, University of Gothenburg, Stockholm University, Workshop on the Future of Labor (at ESMT Berlin), National Tax Association Annual Meeting, New York University, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Central European University, University of Wisconsin-Madison, AEA/ASSA Annual Meeting, UC Berkeley, Haas School of Business, University College London, Columbia Junior Micro-Macro Labor Conference, Bargaining: Experiments, Empirics, and Theory Workshop (BEET), Search and Matching Congress, *Cancelled due to COVID-19*: Trans-Pacific Labor Conference (UC Berkeley IRLE), Erasmus University Rotterdam, CEMFI, University Carlos III, Northeast Labor Symposium for Early Career Economists (at Princeton), IIES Stockholm
- 2018-2019 MIT, UC Berkeley (Economics), Harvard Business School (EM), Stanford Graduate School of Business, Hoover Institution at Stanford University, University of Michigan, Columbia University (Economics & Business School), Microsoft Research New England, Harvard (Economics), University of Chicago Booth School of Business, UC Berkeley (Economics & Haas School of Business), Wharton (BEPP), Princeton University, Kellogg School of Management (Strategy), MIT Sloan (IT), University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Review of Economic Studies Tour (London School of Economics, KU Leuven, Sciences Po), Society of Labor Economists Annual Meeting, CESifo Gender in the Developed and Developing World Conference

Ph.D. Student Advising

Students for whom I have written job market letters and their initial placements by graduation year:

Ini Umosen	2025	Ithaka S+R
Kai Zen	2024	Uber
Cristóbal Otero	2023	Columbia Business School (Economics)
Pedro Pires	2023	NOVA University of Lisbon, School of Business

PhD Defense Committees

Federica Meluzzi	2025
Aksel Vester Augsburg	2025

Other

Citizenship: USA
Date of Birth: July 1990
US Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status: 2023–Present
Last Updated: May 2026